EPP-II 2025-26 GLA U, Mathura
Module-I (Communiation Skills)
Role Play

Role Play as a Tool for Improving Spoken English

1. Introduction: What Is Role Play?

Role play is a speaking activity in which learners take on specific roles and act out real-life or imagined situations. In a language classroom, role-play allows students to practise English in meaningful contexts such as workplaces, interviews, meetings, customer interactions, or academic discussions. Instead of memorising rules or isolated sentences, learners use language actively to communicate ideas, emotions, and solutions.

For non-native English learners, role play is particularly useful because it mirrors professional situations they are likely to face in their careers—team meetings, project discussions, client interactions, technical presentations, and problem-solving conversations.

2. Why Role-Play Is Effective for Learning Spoken English

Role play is effective because it creates a safe and engaging environment for speaking practice. Students are not speaking as themselves but as characters, which reduces fear and hesitation. This shift encourages even shy learners to participate actively.

Through role play, students: - practise **real-life communication** rather than artificial textbook dialogues - learn how language changes according to **context, role, and purpose** - develop both **fluency and accuracy** through repeated practice - gain confidence by speaking in front of peers in a structured manner. Also, they learn to use the language more idiomatically and naturally rather than a forcefully and artificially crafted skill.

3. Types of Role Play Activities

3.1 Guided Role Play

In guided role play, students are given prompts, keywords, or a partially written script. This type is useful for beginners or learners who lack confidence.

Example: A scripted dialogue between an engineer and a client discussing project requirements.

3.2 Semi-Guided Role Play

Here, students are given a situation and roles, but they create their own dialogue. This encourages creativity while still offering structure.

Example: A team meeting where students decide how to complete a project within a deadline.

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3.3 Free Role Play

In free role play, students improvise completely based on the situation. This type helps advanced learners develop spontaneity and natural speech.

Example: Handling an unexpected technical problem during a live presentation.

4. How Role Play Improves Spoken English Skills

4.1 Fluency

Role play encourages continuous speaking, which reduces pauses and hesitation. Students learn to think and respond quickly in English.

4.2 Vocabulary Development

Learners use context-specific vocabulary related to engineering, technology, and the workplace. Repeated exposure helps retain new words.

4.3 Pronunciation and Intonation

Speaking aloud in role play improves pronunciation and helps students practise stress and intonation patterns naturally.

4.4 Grammatical Accuracy

Although the focus is on communication, repeated role play helps students internalise correct sentence structures over time.

5. Strategies for Students While Performing Role Play

To benefit fully from the role-play activities, students should follow these strategies:

- Focus on **clear communication**, not perfect grammar
- Use **simple and direct sentences**
- Maintain **eye contact and appropriate body language**
- Listen actively and respond to others instead of memorising lines
- Accept feedback positively and try to improve in the next performance

6. Benefits of Role Play for B. Tech Students

Role play offers several academic and professional advantages:

- Build confidence in **technical and professional communication**
- Improve performance in **group discussions and interviews**
- Enhance teamwork and collaborative skills
- Prepare students for **real workplace situations**

- Encourage critical thinking and problem-solving through dialogue

7. Sample Role Play Script (Technical Workplace Scenario)

Scenario: Weekly project coordination meeting in a technology company

Context: The team is developing a mobile-based application for monitoring energy usage in smart buildings. The meeting focuses on progress, issues, and next steps.

Characters (6): - **Ravi** – Project Lead - **Meera** – Design Engineer - **Kavya** – Software Developer - **Riya** – Quality Analyst - **Ayaan** – UX Researcher - **Mr. Shah** – Client Representative

Ravi: Good morning, everyone. Let's begin the weekly review meeting. I'd like each of you to briefly fill us in on your progress.

Meera: Good morning. The interface layout is finalised, and the hardware compatibility checks are complete. We may need a small adjustment in sensor placement to improve accuracy.

Mr. Shah: Will this adjustment affect the overall design or cost?

Meera: No, it won't affect the cost. It should improve performance.

Kavya: From the software side, the main features are stable. However, the data synchronisation module needs more testing under heavy usage.

Riya: During quality checks, we noticed slight delays when multiple users log in at the same time. It's not critical, but it should be fixed before release.

Ravi: Thanks, Riya. How much time would that require?

Riya: About two to three days of focused testing.

Ayaan: I'd like to add a user perspective. In our usability tests, some users found the dashboard slightly cluttered. A simpler layout could improve navigation, especially for first-time users.

Ravi: That's helpful, Ayaan. Kavya, can the layout be simplified without changing core features?

Kavya: Yes, we can make small changes to improve clarity without affecting functionality.

Mr. Shah: That sounds good. Ease of use is important for our clients.

Ravi: Agreed. Let's proceed with these updates and review the changes in our next meeting. Thank you, everyone.

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8. Conclusion

Role play is a powerful and practical technique for improving spoken English. By simulating real-life and professional situations, it helps students move beyond fear and hesitation toward confident communication. For non-native English learners, regular role-play practice bridges the gap between technical knowledge and effective expression, making them better prepared for academic and professional success.

Sample Role-Play Scenarios for Script Writing Practice

Scenario 1: Internship Project Discussion

A group of interns is discussing their assigned project with a mentor. One intern feels the deadline is unrealistic, while another believes the team can manage. The mentor asks for a clear plan of action.

Focus: expressing opinions, agreeing and disagreeing politely, proposing solutions

Scenario 2: Technical Problem at the Workplace

A software team faces a sudden bug just before product delivery. One team member suggests a quick fix, while another insists on proper testing. The project lead must plan the next step.

Focus: problem-solving language, justification, decision-making